Who to Ask What

Fourteen questions about Mom's next steps, sorted by the professional who can answer, with room to write what they say.

The facility has told you one thing, a friend another, and something you read online a third. Part of what makes this week hard is that nobody has said which question belongs to whom.

Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one. This guide doesn't answer them and doesn't say which matters most. That depends on Mom's situation and on your state's rules, which is why each question sits beside the kind of person who can speak to it.

Your Medicaid planner

The person who brings the care, financial and Medicaid findings together and works with your family on what happens next.

1. Here is what we know and what we've been told. What else would you want to see before a plan is built?

2. What should we do first?

3. What needs to happen before we apply for Medicaid?

4. Which of the issues on our list need attention now, and which can wait?

5. Which of our decisions should an elder law attorney review, and which belong with a licensed financial or insurance professional?

6. How quickly can we start moving forward, and what do you need from us to begin?

An elder law attorney

1. Here are the decisions we were told may need a legal review. Which of them do you want to look at before anyone acts?

2. What would you need to know about Mom's situation to say whether any legal planning is called for?

A licensed financial or insurance professional

1. Here are the money decisions in front of us. Which of them should wait until you have looked at them?

2. What would you need to see from us before you could say whether any financial planning is called for?

An applications specialist

The person an application is prepared with. If you don't have one yet, these can go to your Medicaid planner.

1. What should we be asking about the timing of an application in Mom's situation?

2. Which documents still need to be collected, and who in the family should collect each one?

The facility's social worker or business office

1. How would you describe Mom's care situation today, and is any further care planning expected?

2. Can we have, in writing, what we are being billed each month and what it covers?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions or tell you which one comes first. If you aren't sure who a question belongs to, write “not sure” beside it and bring it to your Medicaid planner. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and you know whose each one is. The planning interview asks about Mom's situation and gives you a free planning report, so the people you are about to ask can see where your family is starting from.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›